QP 25900493

Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam
MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examination October 2025
Third Semester
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCLIH200 –
Victorian Vistas and Imperial Imaginings : Makers of English Literature
(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Scheme of Valuation

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark.

1. b) Winter Fodder for Livestock [U]/[CO1]
2. b) Fostered a rational, scientific that encouraged innovation [U]/[CO1]
3. d) "The Rime of Ancient Mariner" [K]/[CO2]
4. c) They combine critique with political passion [K]/[CO2]
5. d) It was a tragic and poorly communicated military assault [K]/[CO3]
6. c) Benjamin Disraeli [K]/[CO3]
7. c) Aestheticism [K]/[CO4]
8. c) Novel [K]/[CO4]
9. b) Aurora Leigh [K]/[CO4]
10. a) Jacobite Rising of 1745 [K]/[CO4]

(1x10=10)

Part B
SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Blake's poetic vision - political radicalism and spiritual rebellion - supporter of revolutionary ideals - condemned the moral and institutional tyranny of his age - in London, the phrase "mind-forg'd manacles" articulates the internalisation of social repression - the Chimney Sweeper exposes child exploitation and the complicity of religious institutions - rejection of moralistic Christianity as a redemptive and transformative force. [U]/[CO1]

12. French Revolution deeply impacted Romanticism - inspiring and complicating its themes - writers were drawn to the revolution's ideals of liberty, equality, and fraternity, which aligned with their emphasis on individual freedom - rebellion against authority - William Wordsworth's belief in the transformative power of political upheaval – Coleridge - voicing concerns about the potential for tyranny and chaos – Shelley - emphasized the need for moral and spiritual transformation alongside political change - these poets highlight the complex relationship between Romanticism and the French Revolution, showing how it influenced their exploration of freedom, human nature, and the emotional cost of political change. [U]/[CO1]

13. Defining features of the era - the expansion of periodical literature - created a vibrant arena for the dissemination, reception, and contestation of Romantic ideas - impact of these periodicals on the careers and reception of Romantic poets was substantial - reviews influenced readerships, shaped canons - contributed to the personal reputation of the writers - journals like *The Examiner* and *The Reflector* - promoted progressive ideas -

reached a wide reading public - Shelley and Keats - to circulate their works and create public opinion. [U]/[CO2]

14. Burns articulated egalitarian political ideals – "A Man's a Man for A' That" - asserts human equality regardless of class - support for democratic principles – powerful critique of social hierarchy - expresses equality and dignity. [K]/[CO2]
15. Victorian Dilemma - conflict between faith and doubt, duty and desire, tradition and reform - generated a creative ferment - a search for new syntheses and ways of being - managed this dilemma through the Victorian Compromise - a flexible yet uneasy synthesis. Public life continued to reflect Christian moral codes and imperial pride - private, individuals increasingly questioned authority and explored new worldviews - Charitable endeavours and reformist zeal softened capitalism - Science was often embraced - religion retained its social authority - the language of humanitarianism softened imperial rhetoric - this balancing act preserved social cohesion in an era of profound upheaval. [U]/[CO3]
16. A long political campaign - aimed to give Ireland its own parliament - more control over its internal affairs - began in 1870, led by Isaac Butt - the British Parliament passed the Government of Ireland Act in 1920 - proposed the creation of two separate parliaments: one for Northern Ireland and one for Southern Ireland - the struggle between Irish nationalists and British forces continued - Anglo-Irish Treaty of 1921- created the Irish Free State - a self-governing nation separate from the United Kingdom - showed the inability of Britain to manage the demands of different national groups within its empire - demonstrated that legal reforms through Parliament were not enough to resolve deep divisions, based on religion and national identity - the movement helped pave the way for the later creation of devolved governments in Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland. [An]/[CO3]
17. Best known for deeply emotionl and intellectual poetry – explored love, spirituality, feminism and social justice - tool for social reform - addressed social issues - child labour, slavery, oppression - Sonnets from the Portuguese - emotional intensity - Aurora Leigh - discuss class, marriage, women's rights - The Cry of Children - conditions faced by workers in factories and mines. [An]/[CO4]
18. Articulated the spiritual crisis of the Victorian age through his poetry - portrayed the conflict between religion and science - voiced the emotional and moral dislocation - Dover Beach - mourns the retreat of religious certainty -The Scholar Gypsy - captures the tension between modernity and the rapidly disappearing agrarian ideal - presented the spiritual anxieties with deep introspection. [An]/[CO4]
19. Portrayed 19th-century society with sharp realism and irony - exposed the hypocrisy, vanity and moral emptiness - Victorian high society - Vanity Fair - exposes greed and pretension of the upper and middle classes - social satire and irony - examined the flaws with psycological depth - discussed social mobility and effects of capitalism - brought new moral scepticism and psycological realism to Victorian novel. [An]/[CO4]

(**5x6=30)**

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. The struggle was the outcome of years of mounting discontent, unjust treatment, and increasing frustration under British rule. The colonies, long subjected to excessive control-taxation without representation, oppression and disregard for rights - the colonists yearning for autonomy and self-determination - people striving to reclaim their dignity, protect their liberties, and assert their identity - the Sugar Act - the

Navigation Act - the Stamp Act - the Boston Tea Party - the Declaration of Independence. [U]/[CO1]

21. Prometheus Unbound reworks Greek myth - depict the overthrow of tyranny and the triumph of love and imagination - the figure of Prometheus symbolises spiritual resistance and human potential - reflecting utopian vision of social renewal Shelley's use of myth is more abstract and philosophical - In "Ode to the West Wind", the titular force is personified as a divine power - reminiscent of Greek elemental deities - invocation of the Mediterranean as a dreaming figure and the "Maenad"- like storm fuse natural phenomena with classical ecstasy - Greek mythology becomes a symbolic system - to explore themes of renewal, revolution, and the sublime - use of Greek forms is imaginative - revives their spirit to support a radical poetic vision. [U]/[CO2]
22. Victorian era - defined by unprecedented technological innovation, industrial expansion, and sweeping social transformation - the expansion of railways, steamships, and mechanised production reshaped both the economy and society - with technological innovations such as the telephone, electric lighting and the early automobile, the period was defined by modern advancement - Innovation extended into communications, medicine, domestic life, and education - the telegraph, enabled near-instantaneous long-distance communication - electricity began to replace gas lighting in both factories and homes. Key inventions of the era included the sewing machine, the typewriter, the camera and steam-powered vehicles laid the groundwork for the modern automobile - the steam engine - sewing machines and sanitation advances - changed domestic routines - Steam power revolutionised manufacturing and transportation, powering locomotives, steamships, and mechanised factories - railway lines crisscrossed Britain, connecting rural and urban areas, enhancing trade, and granting people unprecedented mobility. [U]/[CO3]
23. Victorian novel - dominant literary form in 19th-century England - the era's social and cultural changes - wide range of genres - developed distinct characteristics like realism, social commentary, and moral purpose - psychological and social complexity - underwent rapid industrialisation, urbanisation and social reform, the novel - powerful tool for exploring human experience, morality, class structures, gender roles and the individual's place within society - the rise of some of the greatest names in English literature - Charles Dickens - *The Pickwick Papers, Hard Times, Oliver Twist* - Benjamin Disraeli – *Coningsby* - social problem novels - industrial novels - exposed industrial injustices -Thackeray satirized social ambition - *Vanity fair, The Newcomes* - George Eliot explored moral consciousness - *Adam Bede, The Mill on the Floss* - and Thomas Hardy portrayed rural tragedy and fate - *Far from the Madding Crowd, Tess of the d'Urbervilles* - Bronte Sisters - a tool for moral debate, social critique, and character study Charlotte Brontë - *Jane Eyre* – Emily Bronte - *Wuthering Heights* - Anne Bronte - *The Tenant of Wildfell Hall* . [An]/[CO4]

(15x2=30)